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Chicago FBI boss pushed out

Douglas DePodesta forced into early retirement, apparently over issues of fealty to Trump's agenda

By Jason Meisner
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Shortly after Douglas DePodesta became head of the FBI's storied Chicago bureau, he told the Tribune he would love to call it a career in his adopted hometown when he hit the mandatory retirement age in a few years.

"I think I have a lot left in my tank," DePodesta said in May 2025.

Instead, DePodesta's impressive FBI career came to an abrupt end this week. He was forced to retire early due to a falling out with bosses in the Justice Department, apparently over issues with his fealty to

the Trump administration's political agenda, or lack thereof.

In a farewell note to colleagues last week, DePodesta was clear that some type of conflict induced his departure, though he offered no specifics.

"I've never backed down from a fight, as long as it meant our personnel could continue serving the FBI's mission," DePodesta wrote in the message. "Unfortunately, that has proved unpopular over time and my departure is a consequence of that."

Both the FBI and Department of Justice have said they do not comment on personnel matters. Shortly after news of DePodesta's

retirement plans broke, however, one of the FBI's official social media accounts did just that, posting that DePodesta was at odds with the bureau's mission under President Donald Trump.

"It's simple: Anyone who is not on board with THIS FBI under the leadership of President Trump—which has achieved the lowest murder rate ever—is free to leave," the bureau's "rapid response" social media account on X said in response to a post by Kyle Seraphin, an ex-FBI agent and frequent critic of the current administration.

DePodesta, 55, who joined the FBI in 2002 and had served as special agent in charge in Chicago for just under two years, officially



Special Agent in Charge of the FBI Chicago Bureau Doug DePodesta answers questions in his office at the FBI Chicago Division headquarters on May 29, 2025. EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

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Three blue butterflies are placed next to flowers near Big Foot Beach on Monday at Geneva Lake in Wisconsin. Three children died Friday after a boat capsized during a massive storm. ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Children who drowned in Geneva Lake 'deeply loved'

Father sets up online fundraiser for charity in memory of kids who died in boat accident

By Caroline Kubzansky
and Susan Sarkauskas
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The father of two of the three children who drowned in Geneva Lake in a massive storm Friday said his children were "deeply loved" in a GoFundMe the family launched to raise money for a charity in their memory.

The children were identified as Abigail Oswald, 7, and Caleb Oswald, 6, by their father, Brad Oswald, who organized the verified fundraiser.

Abigail "was kind, loving, and wise beyond her years" and wanted to become a teacher, the fundraiser said. She loved to dance and swim.

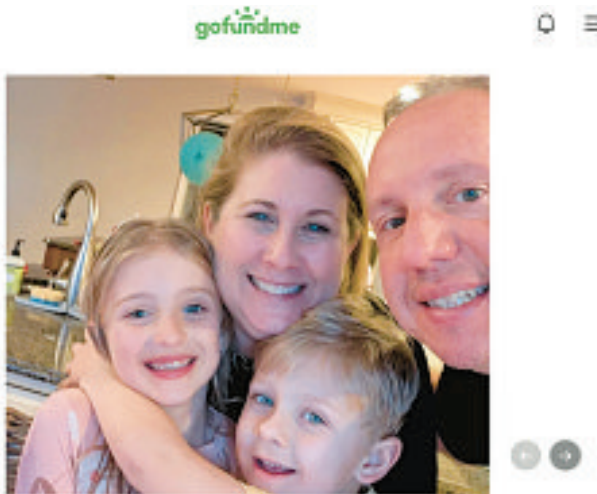
"Caleb had the sweetest heart and a smile that could brighten anyone's day," the fundraiser said.

"Caleb found happiness in the simple things, and his laughter and excitement were contagious." He loved trucks, Chick-fil-A and singing and dancing.

"Caleb and Abigail were more than brother and sister — they were best friends," the fundraiser said.

Wheaton school officials Wednesday confirmed that two of the three children were students in its district.

"On behalf of Community Unit School District 200, our deepest condolences are with the family and friends of the children who died in a tragic boating incident in Lake Geneva on July 3," a district spokesperson said. "We ask that you join us in supporting these families during this difficult



Charity Fund for Caleb & Abigail Oswald

Abigail Oswald, 7, and Caleb Oswald, 6, are two of the three children who drowned in the Geneva Lake, Wisconsin, boating accident during a storm. GOFUNDME

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Future of Harold's Chicken in court

Chicken coup? Family fights over control of the famous business

By Sam Charles
and Zareen Syed
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Six months after the death of Harold's Chicken Shack CEO Kristen Pierce-Sherrod, the question remains: Who owns the iconic Chicago restaurant brand?

Pierce-Sherrod's five adult children claim it's their birthright, pointing to a mysterious, still-contested "will" that, they say, makes clear their mother's final wishes.

"This is our brand, our everything — our mom worked for many, many years to make sure that her father's legacy thrives," Pierce-Sherrod's daughter Kasee Gill recently told the Tribune.

Pierce-Sherrod's widower, Vincent Sherrod, meanwhile, has enlisted former Chicago Mayor Lori Lightfoot as his lawyer to argue that the purported "will" — which wasn't referenced until two months after Pierce-Sherrod's death — is fake. In fact, Sherrod believes his wife "actually made an intentional decision to die intestate" — that is, without a last will and testament.

The future of Harold's Chicken Shack empire may soon be determined by a Will County probate judge. A status hearing is scheduled for later this month.

Pierce-Sherrod and her husband were married more than 14 years before she died Jan. 11, according to court records. Her husband Sherrod was named her "health care agent" four months earlier. Weeks before her death, Sherrod was granted guardianship by a Will County judge.

"As part of the Guardianship Petition, Mr. Sherrod provided the mandatory Report of Physician which attested to Mrs. Sherrod's disability and the fact that she was 'TOTALLY incapable of making personal and financial decisions,'" Lightfoot said on Sherrod's behalf in a recent court filing.

"What is really at issue is Petitioner Gill and her Gill siblings have been denied free access to revenues

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INSIDE

Bedard out 4 months after shoulder surgery



The Blackhawks will be without their star center for at least the first month of the regular season after he underwent surgery on his left shoulder.

US will give Ukraine license to make Patriot missiles

By Lorne Cook, Seung Min Kim
and Suzan Fraser
ASSOCIATED PRESS

ANKARA, Turkey — President Donald Trump said at a NATO summit Wednesday in Turkey that the U.S. will give Ukraine a license to make Patriot air defense systems to counter missile attacks

from Russia in their more than four-year war, a huge coup for Kyiv, which has long requested the technology.

Allowing foreign manufacture of Patriots, which the U.S. had resisted, was a turnaround for Trump that mirrored his day at the NATO meeting.

Upon arriving, he lashed out

at European partners for resisting his efforts to take control of Greenland and for not supporting his war in Iran. But by day's end, he described a gathering of unity and "tremendous love," and praised member nations on their progress in increasing their defense spending.

NATO's European members

plus Canada have scrambled to meet the alliance's increased defense spending targets, which Trump has demanded as the U.S. draws down troops in Europe and insists the continent take more responsibility for its own security.

Trump had reopened old

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